Consequence Attribution Module (CAAM)

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Canonical Definition

Consequence Attribution Module (CAAM) defines the structural conditions under which the consequences of actions performed on behalf of a governed identity remain attributable, verifiable, evidence-supported, and continuously governable throughout the complete identity lifecycle.

CAAM governs consequence attribution.

The module establishes the governance conditions required to ensure that every governance outcome can be attributed to the legitimate participant responsible for the corresponding action or decision.

Actions create consequences.

Governance identifies who remains accountable for them.

CAAM governs that attribution.

Module Operational Role

CAAM defines the consequence attribution layer of RIS.

Its role is to preserve clear accountability between governed actions, governance decisions, and their resulting consequences.

Module Operational Space

CAAM governs:

- consequence attribution,
- governance accountability,
- action attribution,
- responsibility verification,
- governance outcomes,
- accountable consequences,
- responsibility evidence,
- consequence traceability.

Module Function

The module applies wherever organizations must determine who remains accountable for the consequences associated with actions performed on behalf of a governed identity.

Minimum Implementation Framework

1. Define the Consequence Attribution Object

Identify the governed identity, the governance action, and the resulting consequence requiring attribution.

2. Define Attribution Conditions

Establish governance conditions governing responsibility linkage, evidence requirements, attribution rules, and accountability validation.

3. Define Attribution Failure Logic

Identify conditions where consequences become unattributable, ambiguous, unsupported by evidence, disputed, or governance-invalid.

4. Define Governance Response Define governance actions for investigation, responsibility confirmation, reassignment, corrective action, or governance escalation.

5. Preserve Attribution Records

Preserve governance decisions, responsibility records, supporting evidence, consequence history, and attribution documentation.

Use Case 1 — Enterprise Identity Governance

Scenario

An unauthorized modification of a governed enterprise identity results in operational disruption.

Application

CAAM reconstructs the governance chain and attributes responsibility to the participant responsible for the authorized governance action.

Result

The organization establishes clear accountability supported by governance evidence.

Use Case 2 — AI Identity Governance

Scenario

A governed AI identity performs an authorized operational action that produces unintended organizational consequences.

Application

CAAM attributes the governance consequences to the responsible governance participant using preserved evidence and governance records.

Result

Governance accountability remains transparent, verifiable, and continuously governable throughout the complete identity lifecycle.

Canonical Closing Statement

Responsibility becomes meaningful only when consequences remain attributable. Consequence Attribution preserves governance integrity by ensuring that every governance outcome remains connected to the participant responsible for creating it throughout the complete identity lifecycle.

Related Documents

→ Responsibility Integrity Standard (RIS)

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Canonical Source

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